

# Mohammad Hossein Eslami

## CURRICULUM VITAE

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### EDUCATION

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| Sep 2019 – Jan 2023 | <b>M.A. in Theatre Directing</b><br><i>Tehran University of Art, Tehran, Iran</i><br><b>Thesis:</b> A Study of the Representation of Identity in the Work of Elizabeth LeCompte<br><b>Practical thesis:</b> <i>Maid to Marry</i> , after Eugène Ionesco<br><b>Advisors:</b> Prof. Kamran Sepehran, Prof. Esmaeil Shafiee<br><b>GPA:</b> 4.0 / 4.0 (18.42 / 20) |
| Sep 2013 – Sep 2018 | <b>B.Sc. in Software Engineering</b><br><i>Shahid Beheshti University, Tehran, Iran</i><br><b>Final project:</b> <i>The Rock</i> , an animation based on Albert Camus's <i>The Myth of Sisyphus</i><br><b>Advisor:</b> Prof. Ahmad Ali Abin                                                                                                                    |
| 2009 – 2013         | <b>Diploma in Mathematics and Physics</b><br><i>Salam High School, Tehran, Iran</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |

### RESEARCH INTERESTS

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|----------------------|--------------------------|
| Postdramatic Theatre | Intermediality Studies   |
| Political Theatre    | Gender and Queer Studies |

### PUBLICATIONS

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|------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Manuscript in progress | Eslami, M. H., & Sepehran, K. <b>Theatrical Trial: Elizabeth LeCompte's Artistic Inquiry into Identity in <i>The Emperor Jones</i> and <i>To You, the Birdie!</i></b> |
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### HONOURS & AWARDS

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|------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2019 | Ranked 3rd nationally, Master's Entrance Examination (Theatre Directing) |
| 2013 | Top 1%, National University Entrance Examination                         |
| 2010 | Semi-finalist, National Literature Olympiad                              |

### THEATRE WORK

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| 2026     | <b><i>Mephisto For Ever</i></b><br><i>Director, Producer &amp; Scene Designer, Labkhand Theatre Complex, Tehran, Iran</i> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Based on Tom Lanoye's play and Klaus Mann's novel <i>Mephisto</i>; in rehearsal, opening November 2026.</li><li>Metatheatrical staging of a troupe performing itself, combining classical and modern acting, puppetry, contemporary dance and video mapping.</li><li>Designed a modular set of one-metre cubes, a trussed arch and a stepped platform, and a plexiglass puppet stage; key sequences previsualised in 3D.</li></ul> |
| Nov 2024 | <b><i>Mixed Sandwich</i></b><br><i>Media Producer &amp; Media Projection Coordinator, Tehran, Iran</i> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Independent production directed by Mohammad Hossein Heshmati and Aref Hassanzadeh.</li><li>Produced the media content and coordinated projection during performances.</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| 2022     | <b><i>The Good Person of Szechwan</i></b><br><i>Scene Designer, Mehregan Theater, Tehran, Iran</i> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Set design for Bertolt Brecht's play, directed by Masoud Jahandideh.</li><li>Designed a wooden stage floor that produced sounds under the actors' movement, and lightweight props for fast scene changes in view of the audience.</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| 2018     | <b><i>In Front of City Theater</i></b><br><i>Director &amp; Co-Scene Designer, Neauphle-le-Château Theater, Tehran, Iran</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |

- Four-episode play by Salman Alighardashi on the life of Sohrab A'raabi, drawing on classical Persian literature and the myth of Rostam and Sohrab from the *Shahnameh*.
- Year-long process with a group of fifteen; choreography inspired by Pina Bausch's trust dance; five tracks composed in rehearsal, blending alternative rock and Persian folk music.
- Co-designed with Mohsen Khamechian a metal set inspired by 3D children's books, resembling turning pages.

2017

***Saturday Nights (concert performance)***

*Actor & Co-Choreographer, Independent Theater of Tehran, Iran*

- With Farnoosh Azor, choreographed eight dance pieces and two short plays staged around the music of the rock band Padir.

2016

***Asgardia***

*Director & Co-Playwright, Mashayekhi Theater Hall, Tehran, Iran*

- Co-written with Reyhane Yazdani: six strangers on a mission to the first nation in space, intercut with a mythic line drawn from the story of Adam and Eve.
- Built the group from scratch; a 14-month process with eleven actors, most of them performing professionally for the first time.

2015

***A Requiem for Oedipus***

*Actor (Chorus), Shahid Beheshti University, Tehran, Iran*

- Student production directed by Abtin Gholampour with the university's theatre association and philosophy society; the chorus was reduced to four performers after research on the chorus in Sophocles.

## ACADEMIC PRODUCTIONS

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2023

***Maid to Marry***

*Director (practical MA thesis), Tehran University of Art*

- Based on Eugène Ionesco's short absurdist play, reworked around identity and education; supervised by Prof. Esmaeil Shafiee.
- Three simultaneous layers: a "cyber" version of the script on monitors, the play on stage, and seven teenagers as performers rather than actors; the original text treated as raw material, after Elizabeth LeCompte.

2022

***King Lear***

*Actor, Tehran University of Art*

- Final project of the Advanced Directing 2 course, directed by Hojjat Salimi.

2021

***King Lear***

*Director, Tehran University of Art*

- Final project of the Advanced Directing 2 course, led by Prof. Esmaeil Shafiee.
- Staged the scene in which Lear curses his own children in the barren desert, in eight versions emphasising different directorial elements (lighting, staging, mise-en-scène), combined into one final performance.

2021

***The Bear***

*Director, Tehran University of Art*

- Final project of the Advanced Directing 1 course, led by Prof. Esmaeil Shafiee.
- Online performance of Anton Chekhov's play combining animation and live acting, made during the COVID-19 pandemic.

2020

***The Proposal***

*Director, Tehran University of Art*

- Final project of the Principles of Directing course, led by Prof. Esmaeil Shafiee.
- Staged Chekhov's text without cuts or additions, using the physical vocabulary of commedia dell'arte.

## ACADEMIC WRITING

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2021

***A Critical Analysis of Florian Zeller's The Father***

*Final paper, Play Analysis course, Prof. Kamran Sepehran*

**PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE**

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2016 – 2018

**Mahtaab Digital Marketing Agency***Art Director, Tehran, Iran*

- Art direction for video advertisements and events.

**WORKSHOPS & TRAINING**

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2023

**Dramaturgy Workshop***Farvardin Playwriting School, Tehran, Iran*

- With Keivan Sarreshte: the history and styles of dramaturgy, and adapting classical texts for contemporary performance.

2021 – 2022

**Advanced Playwriting Course***Farvardin Playwriting School, Tehran, Iran*

- Fifteen-month course with twelve practising theatre-makers, including Mohammad Charmshir, Erfan Nazer and Mohammadreza Aliakbari.

2021

**Drama and Performance Workshop***Farvardin Playwriting School, Tehran, Iran*

- With Mohammadreza Aliakbari: acting and directing techniques after Meyerhold, Eugenio Barba's methods, and the Theatre Workshop of Tehran and the Shiraz Arts Festival in the 1970s.

2021

**Personality Psychology in Playwriting***Farvardin Playwriting School, Tehran, Iran*

- With Azimeh Sattari: psychological analysis of dramatic characters, including personality disorders in well-known plays.

2015 – 2018

**Contemporary Dance***Private classes with Nima Hosseinzadeh, Tehran, Iran*

- Contemporary dance, body movement and choreography.

2016

**Theatre Facing Society Workshop***Tehran University Experimental Theatre Center, Tehran, Iran*

- With Christoph Pauer: applied and pedagogical theatre with marginalised communities.

**SKILLS & LANGUAGES**

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Theatre

Directing, Playwriting, Scene Design, Dramaturgy, Theatre Pedagogy

Film &amp; Media

Screenwriting, Editing, Videography, 3D Previsualisation

Software

Final Cut Pro, Adobe Premiere Pro, Adobe After Effects, Adobe Audition, Apple Motion, Previs Pro

Languages

Persian (native) · English (IELTS Academic 8.0: Listening 8.5, Reading 8.5, Writing 7.0, Speaking 7.0) · Arabic (basic)

**EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES**

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2015

**Founding Member, Khiyal Theatre Group**

- Co-founded a professional company growing out of the Shahid Beheshti University Theatre Association.

2014 – 2016

**Board Member, SBU Theatre Association**

- Planned and ran the association's productions and events; led its training programme for new members (2015–2016) and its introduction programme for new students (2014).